

Apple AI: Love it and hate it

Thank you, Apple, for finally making a play in the AI world! But what sets Apple AI apart is its focus on privacy and data security, a much-needed conversation in the rapidly evolving world of AI. As we embrace the benefits of AI, we need to address the concerns around data privacy and security. LLMs, the foundation for Generative AI, rely on user data to train themselves, raising concerns about privacy, security, and surveillance. And despite all those privacy concerns, we'll continue to use Generative AI extensively as we move towards an AI-first world.

AI and Privacy on the same boat?

With Apple Intelligence, data will be accessed across apps, and Siri will fetch data across apps, add context, and be a lot more powerful and capable. And when in need of more power and compute, it will dial into Apple's Private Cloud Compute (PCC) for assistance. This cloud computing prowess will enable complex tasks but also relies on Apple's promise to protect user data. This integration will make our lives easier but also raises questions about data handling.

Apple's approach to data privacy is commendable, as they're taking it head-on and making serious efforts to build systems that will protect users from misuse of data and protect user privacy. Their claim that data sent to the private secure cloud won't be stored, will be erased once the request is completed, and won't be accessible to any third party or Apple itself, is reassuring. However, only time will tell if this promise holds. This move by Apple to bring user data privacy and security to the centre stage will force all the big players in the AI ecosystem to take a long and hard look at their user data protection policies and systems. If they ignore it, Apple will have a distinct advantage over the rest, and Apple will juice every single drop out of it to make every other device look compromised. The industry needed this move. And Apple has made it, in typical Apple style.



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Soham Raninga
Editor-in-Chief

Upgrade or...

What else is typically Apple about it? Well, Apple plans to make money with its AI play, a lot of it. The buzz around Apple Intelligence getting a paid "plus" variant is doing the rounds. Apple also wants you to buy its latest devices to be able to make the most of its Apple Intelligence system. But here's the thing - why not open Apple Intelligence to all iOS 18 qualifying devices and use Private Cloud Compute wherever the on-device capabilities fall short? Sure, the older Apple devices will take longer to process but hey, that's better than labelling them as incapable for Apple AI.

Why make a one-year-old iPhone 15 look dated (unless it's got "Pro" written on it) and incapable? It's almost like Apple is artificially limiting the potential of Apple Intelligence to push sales of the latest devices. Come iOS 18 and my trusty old iPhone 14 Pro looks like a feature phone, thanks to Apple Intelligence! Apple will make money on software and hardware, in a way forcing you to dump older Apple devices, as it's supposedly missing the hardware prowess that's needed to do on-device AI compute.

As we navigate this AI-first world, we need to consider the implications of our choices. Do we prioritise convenience over privacy? Do we trust Apple to keep our data safe? What are your thoughts on Apple Intelligence and the push for user data privacy? Do you agree it's a step in the right direction? Is Apple's decision to limit Apple Intelligence to the latest devices justified? Write to me at soham@digit.in, I'd love to know your opinions on this one! **d**



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